

Formula List for Diffraction

1. Grating formula

$$(a+b) \sin \theta = n \lambda$$

Where;

- $(a+b)$ = Grating element
- θ = Angle of Diffraction
- n = order of Diffraction
- λ = Wavelength of wave getting Diffracted

2. Grating Element

$$(a+b) = \frac{1}{N}$$

Where;

- $(a+b)$ = Grating element
- N = Number of lines per unit length of Grating

3. Resolving power of Grating (R.P.)

$$R.P. = \frac{\lambda}{d\lambda} = mN$$

Where;

- N = Number of lines per unit length of Grating
- m = order of Diffraction
- λ = Mean Wavelength of sources to be resolved
- $d\lambda$ = Difference between Wavelength of sources to be resolved

DIFFRACTION PROBLEMS

Q1. A diffraction grating used at normal incidence gives a yellow line ($\lambda = 6000 \text{ \AA}$) in a certain spectral order superimposed on a blue line ($\lambda = 4800 \text{ \AA}$) of next higher order. If the angle of diffraction is $\sin^{-1}(3/4)$ calculate the grating element.

Given:- $\lambda_1 = 6000 \text{ \AA} = 6 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$; $\lambda_2 = 4800 \text{ \AA} = 4.8 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$; $\theta = \sin^{-1}\left(\frac{3}{4}\right)$

Formula:- $(a+b) \sin \theta = n \lambda$; $n = 1, 2, 3, 4, \dots$

Solution:- for given $(a+b)$ and θ ; $n \propto 1/\lambda$

$$(a+b) \sin \theta = n \lambda_1$$

$$(a+b) \sin \theta = (n+1) \lambda_2$$

$$n \lambda_1 = (n+1) \lambda_2$$

$$\frac{\lambda_1}{\lambda_2} = 1 + \frac{1}{n}$$

Therefore, $n = 4$

$$(a+b) = \frac{n \lambda_1}{\sin \theta} = \frac{4 \times 6 \times 10^{-5}}{\frac{3}{4}} = 32 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$$

Ans:- The grating element is $3.2 \times 10^{-4} \text{ cm}$.

Q2. Monochromatic light of wavelength $6560 \text{ \AA}$ falls normally on a grating 2 cm wide. The first order spectrum is produced at an angle of $16^\circ 17'$ from the normal. Calculate the total number of lines on the grating.

Given:- $\lambda = 6560 \text{ \AA} = 6560 \times 10^{-8} \text{ cm}$; width = 2 cm ; $n = 1$; $\theta = 16.28^\circ$

Formula:- $(a+b) \sin \theta = n \lambda$

$$a + b = \frac{1}{(N) \text{ Number of lines per cm}}$$

Total number of lines = N x width

Solution:- $(a+b) = \frac{n\lambda}{\sin\theta} = \frac{6560}{\sin 16.28} \times 10^{-8} = 2.34 \times 10^{-4} \text{ cm}$

$$\text{Number of lines per cm} = \frac{1}{a+b} = 4273$$

$$\text{Total no. of lines} = 4273 \times 2 = 8547$$

Ans:- There will be 8547 lines on the grating.

Q3. A parallel beam of light is incident on a plane transmission grating having 3000 lines/cm. A third order diffraction is observed at 30° . calculate the wavelength of the line.

Given:- $a+b = 1/3000$; $n=3$; $\theta=30$

Formula:- $(a+b) \sin\theta = n\lambda$, $n=1,2,3...$

Solution:- $\lambda = \frac{a+b}{n} \times \sin\theta$

$$= \frac{1}{3000 \times 3} \times \sin 30$$

$$= \frac{1}{9000 \times 2} = 5.555 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$$

Ans:- The wavelength of the line is $5.555 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$.

Q4. The visible spectrum ranges from $4000\text{\AA}$ to $7000\text{\AA}$. Find the angular breadth of the first order visible spectrum produced by a plane grating having 6000 lines/cm when light is incident normally on the grating.

Given:- $\lambda_1 = 4000\text{\AA} = 4 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$ $\lambda_2 = 7000\text{\AA} = 7 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$ $n=1$

$a+b = 1/6000 \text{ lines per cm}$

Formula:- $(a+b) \sin\theta = n\lambda$

Solution:- $(a+b)\sin \theta_1 = \lambda_1$

$$\theta_1 = \sin^{-1} \frac{\lambda_1}{a+b} = \sin^{-1}(4 \times 10^{-5} \times 6000) = 13.88^\circ$$

$$(a+b)\sin \theta_2 = \lambda_2$$

$$\theta_2 = \sin^{-1} \frac{\lambda_2}{a+b} = \sin^{-1}(7 \times 10^{-5} \times 6000) = 24.83^\circ$$

$$\theta_2 - \theta_1 = 24.83 - 13.88 = 10.95^\circ$$

Ans :- The Angular separation = 10.95°

Q5. In plane transmission grating the angle of diffraction for the second order principal maxima for the wavelength 5×10^{-5} cm is 35° . Calculate the number of lines/cm on the diffraction grating.

Given:- $\lambda = 5 \times 10^{-5}$ cm ; $\theta = 35^\circ$; $n=2$

Formula:- $(a+b)\sin \theta = n\lambda$; $\frac{1}{a+b}$ = number of lines/cm

Solution:- $a+b = \frac{n\lambda}{\sin \theta} = \frac{2 \times 5 \times 10^{-5}}{\sin 35^\circ} = 1.74 \times 10^{-4}$

$$\text{Number of lines per cm} = \frac{1}{a+b} = \frac{1}{1.74 \times 10^{-4}} = 5735$$

Ans:- The number of lines per cm is 5735.

Q6. A grating has 620 ruling/mm and is 0.5 mm wide. What is the smallest wavelength interval that can be resolved in the third order at $\lambda = 481$ nm?

Given:- $N = 620 \times 0.5 = 310$; $\lambda = 481 \times 10^{-9}$ m ; $m=3$

Formula:- $\frac{\lambda}{d\lambda} = mN$

Solution:- $d\lambda = \frac{\lambda}{mN} = \frac{481 \times 10^{-9}}{3 \times 310} = 0.5172 \times 10^{-9}$ m

$$d_{\lambda} = 0.5172 \text{ \AA}$$

Ans:- The smallest wavelength interval is 0.5172 \AA

Q7. Calculate the minimum number of lines required on grating that can just resolve the two sodium lines $\lambda_1 = 5890 \text{ \AA}$ and $\lambda_2 = 5893 \text{ \AA}$ in third order.

Given:- $\lambda_1 = 5890 \times 10^{-8} \text{ cm}$, $\lambda_2 = 5893 \times 10^{-8} \text{ cm}$, $m = 3$

Formula:- Resolving power $= \frac{\lambda}{d\lambda} = mN$

Solution:- $\lambda = \frac{\lambda_1 + \lambda_2}{2} = \frac{(5890 + 5893) \times 10^{-8}}{2} = 5893 \times 10^{-8} \text{ cm}$

$$d = (5893 - 5890) \times 10^{-8} = 3 \times 10^{-8} \text{ cm}$$

$$N = \frac{\lambda}{m d\lambda} = \frac{5893 \times 10^{-8}}{3 \times 3 \times 10^{-8}} = 327$$

Ans:- Minimum of 327 lines are required on the grating.

Q8. Calculate the maximum order of diffraction maxima seen from plane transmission grating with 2500 lines per inch if light of wavelength 6900 \AA falls normally on it.

Given:- $N = \frac{1}{a+b} = 2500 \text{ lines/inch} = 2500 \times 2.54 \times 10^{-2} = 63 \text{ lines/cm}$

$$\lambda = 6900 \text{ \AA} = 6900 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$$

Formula:- $(a+b) \sin \theta = n \lambda$

Solution:- for $n = n_{\max}$, $\sin \theta = 1$

$$n_{\max} = \frac{a+b}{\lambda} = 2.3$$

Ans:- Maximum order of diffraction is 2

Single Slit and Double Slit

1. A slit of width 0.3mm is illuminated by a light of wavelength $5890\text{\AA}$. A lens whose focal length is 40 cm forms a Fraunhofer diffraction pattern. Calculate the distance between first and the next bright image from the axis. (Ans: 0.0393 cm)

Diffraction Grating

1. In a plane transmission grating the angle of diffraction for second order principal maximum for the wavelength $5 \times 10^{-5} \text{ cm}$ is 30° . Calculate the number of lines/cm of grating surface. (Ans: 5000)
2. In a plane transmission grating the angle of diffraction for the first order principal maximum is 20° for a wavelength $6500\text{\AA}$. Calculate the number of lines in one cm of the grating surface. (Ans: 5262)

Order of Spectrum

1. A plane transmission grating has 5000 lines/cm.
 - a) Find out the highest order of spectrum observed if incident light has $\lambda = 6000\text{\AA}$.
 - b) If opaque spaces between the slits are exactly 2 times the transparent space and the maximum order observed is three, find which order of spectra will be absent.
(Ans: 3rd order; 3,6,9 order)

2. Calculate the maximum order of diffraction maxima seen from a plane diffraction grating having 5500 lines per cm if light of wavelength $5896\text{\AA}$ falls normally on it. (Ans: 3)
3. The visible spectrum range from $4000\text{\AA}$ to $5000\text{\AA}$. Find the angular breadth of the first order visible spectrum produced by a plane grating having 6000 lines/cm when light is incident normally on the grating. (Ans: 3.57°)
4. In a plane transmission grating, the angle of diffraction for second order principal maxima of wavelength $5 \times 10^{-5}\text{ cm}$ is 35° . Calculate the number of lines/cm on diffraction grating.

Grating Element

1. A diffraction grating used at normal incidence gives yellow line ($\lambda = 6000\text{\AA}$) in a certain spectral order superimposed on a blue line ($\lambda = 4800\text{\AA}$) of the next higher order. If angle of diffraction is $\sin^{-1}(3/4)$, calculate the grating element. (Ans: 3.2×10^{-6})

Resolving Power

1. A plane grating just resolves two lines in the second order. Calculate the grating element if $d\lambda = 6\text{\AA}$, $\lambda = 6 \times 10^{-5}\text{ cm}$ and width of ruled surface is 2 cm. (Ans: 4×10^{-3})
2. Find the minimum number of lines in a plane diffraction grating required to just resolve the sodium doublet ($5890\text{\AA}$ and $5896\text{\AA}$) in the (i) first order (ii) second order. (Ans: 982, 481)

3. A grating has 620 rulings/mm and is 5.05 mm wide. What is the smallest wavelength interval that can be resolved in the third order at $\lambda = 481 \text{ nm}$? (Ans: 2.58×10^{-9})